

Linear velocity calibration

This lesson uses the Raspberry Pi as an example. For Raspberry Pi and Jetson-Nano boards, you need to open a terminal on the host computer and enter the command to enter the Docker container. Once inside the Docker container, enter the commands mentioned in this lesson in the terminal. For instructions on entering the Docker container from the host computer, refer to **[01.Robot Configuration and Operation Guide] -- [5.Enter Docker (For JETSON Nano and RPi 5)]**. For Orin and RDK boards, simply open the terminal and enter the commands mentioned in this lesson.

1. Program Description

Run the program and adjust the parameters in the dynamic parameter adjuster to calibrate the car's linear speed. To visually demonstrate the linear speed, instruct the car to move straight forward for 1 meter and observe its actual distance to see if it is within the error range.

2. Starting the Program

2.1. Startup Commands

For the Raspberry Pi 5 and jetson nano controller, you must first enter the Docker container. For the Orin and RDK controller, this is not necessary.

Entering the Docker container (see the Docker course for steps: 4. Docker Startup Script).

All subsequent commands must be executed within the same Docker container (see the Docker course for steps: 3. Docker Commit and Multi-Terminal Entry).

Start the chassis data: Enter the command in the terminal.

```
ros2 launch yahboomcar_bringup yahboomcar_bringup_A1_launch.py
```

```
root@raspberrypi: /
File Edit Tabs Help
got segment base_link
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1755157941.620678910] [robot_state_publisher]:
got segment camera_link
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1755157941.620688336] [robot_state_publisher]:
got segment imu_link
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1755157941.620698873] [robot_state_publisher]:
got segment laser
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1755157941.620707650] [robot_state_publisher]:
got segment left_front_wheel_joint
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1755157941.620717132] [robot_state_publisher]:
got segment left_rear_wheel_hinge
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1755157941.620726391] [robot_state_publisher]:
got segment left_steering_hinge_joint
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1755157941.620734965] [robot_state_publisher]:
got segment right_front_wheel_joint
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1755157941.620745576] [robot_state_publisher]:
got segment right_rear_wheel_hinge
[robot_state_publisher-2] [INFO] [1755157941.620755039] [robot_state_publisher]:
got segment right_steering_hinge_joint
[joint_state_publisher-1] [INFO] [1755157942.125945703] [joint_state_publisher]:
Waiting for robot_description to be published on the robot_description topic...
[imu_filter_madgwick_node-5] [INFO] [1755157942.341251881] [imu_filter_madgwick]:
First IMU message received.
```

```
ros2 run yahboomcar_bringup calibrate_linear_A1
```

The following image is displayed successfully.

```
root@raspberrypi: /# ros2 run yahboomcar_bringup calibrate_linear_A1
finish init work
```

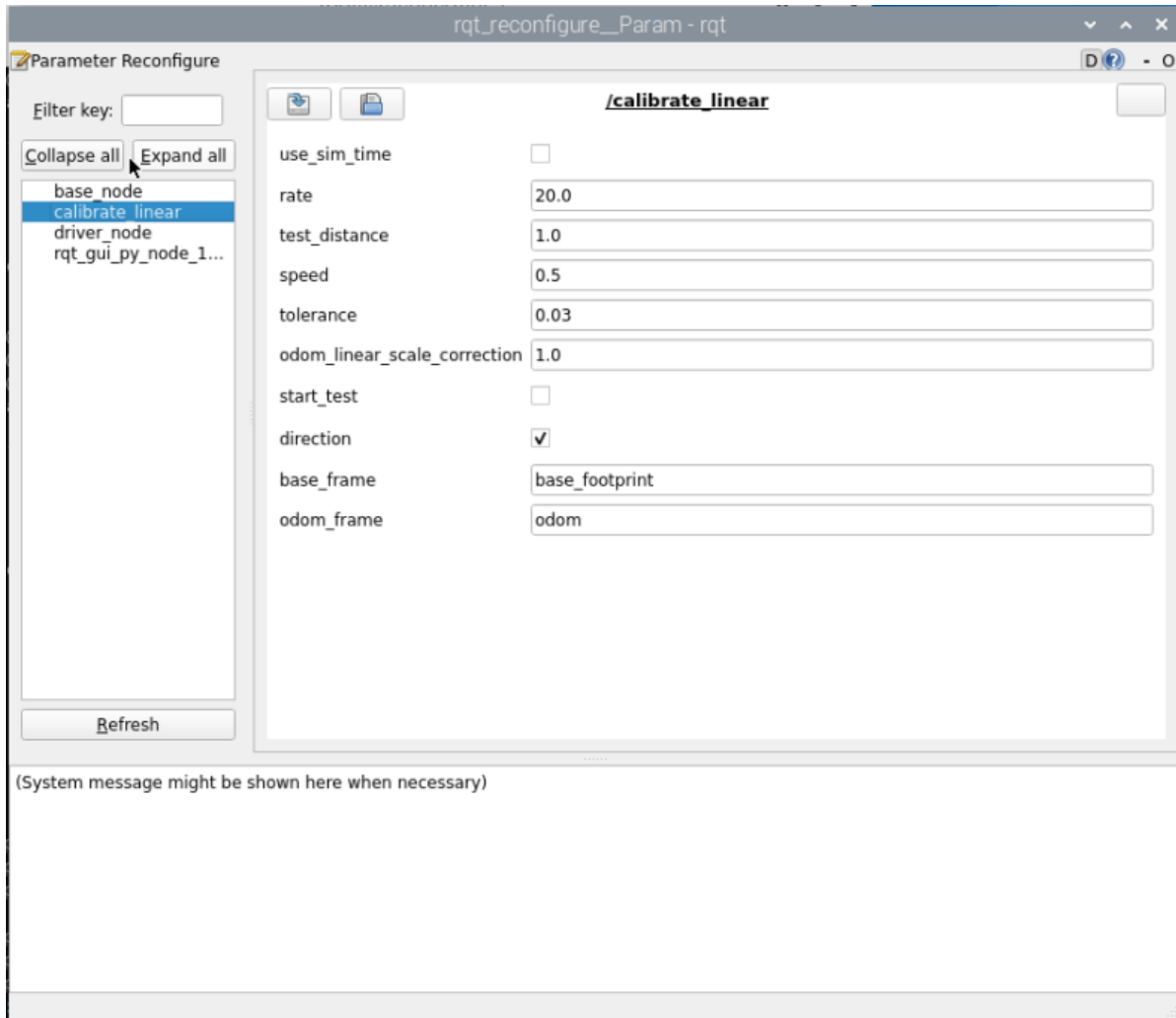
If the following error message appears during runtime indicating that no TF transformations were found, press **Ctrl+C** to exit the program and run it again.

```
File "/root/yahboomcar_ros2_ws/yahboomcar_ws/install/yahboomcar_bringup/lib/yahboomcar_bringup/calibrate_linear_A1", line 33, in <module>
    sys.exit(load_entry_point('yahboomcar-bringup==0.0.0', 'console_scripts', 'calibrate_linear_A1')())
File "/root/yahboomcar_ros2_ws/yahboomcar_ws/install/yahboomcar_bringup/lib/python3.10/site-packages/yahboomcar_bringup/calibrate_linear_A1.py", line 148, in main
    rclpy.spin(class_calibratelinear)
File "/opt/ros/humble/local/lib/python3.10/dist-packages/rclpy/__init__.py", line 226, in spin
    executor.spin_once()
File "/opt/ros/humble/local/lib/python3.10/dist-packages/rclpy/executors.py", line 751, in spin_once
    self._spin_once_impl(timeout_sec)
File "/opt/ros/humble/local/lib/python3.10/dist-packages/rclpy/executors.py", line 748, in _spin_once_impl
    raise handler.exception()
File "/opt/ros/humble/local/lib/python3.10/dist-packages/rclpy/task.py", line 254, in __call__
    self._handler.send(None)
File "/opt/ros/humble/local/lib/python3.10/dist-packages/rclpy/executors.py", line 447, in handler
    await call_coroutine(entity, arg)
File "/opt/ros/humble/local/lib/python3.10/dist-packages/rclpy/executors.py", line 361, in _execute_timer
    await await_or_execute(tmr.callback)
File "/opt/ros/humble/local/lib/python3.10/dist-packages/rclpy/executors.py", line 107, in await_or_execute
    return callback(*args)
File "/root/yahboomcar_ros2_ws/yahboomcar_ws/install/yahboomcar_bringup/lib/python3.10/site-packages/yahboomcar_bringup/calibrate_linear_A1.py", line 114, in on_timer
    self.x_start = self.get_position().transform.translation.x
File "/root/yahboomcar_ros2_ws/yahboomcar_ws/install/yahboomcar_bringup/lib/python3.10/site-packages/yahboomcar_bringup/calibrate_linear_A1.py", line 136, in get_position
    trans = self.tf_buffer.lookup_transform(self.odom_frame, self.base_frame, now)
File "/opt/ros/humble/lib/python3.10/site-packages/tf2_ros/buffer.py", line 136, in lookup_transform
    return self.lookup_transform_core(target_frame, source_frame, time)
tf2.LookupException: "odom" passed to lookupTransform argument target_frame does not exist.
```

Open the dynamic parameter adjuster and run the following command in the terminal:

```
ros2 run rqt_reconfigure rqt_reconfigure
```

Click the **calibrate_linear** node in the node options on the left:



Note: The above nodes may not appear when you first open the application. Click Refresh to see all nodes. The **calibrate_linear** node displayed is the node for calibrating linear velocity.

The rqt interface parameters are described as follows:

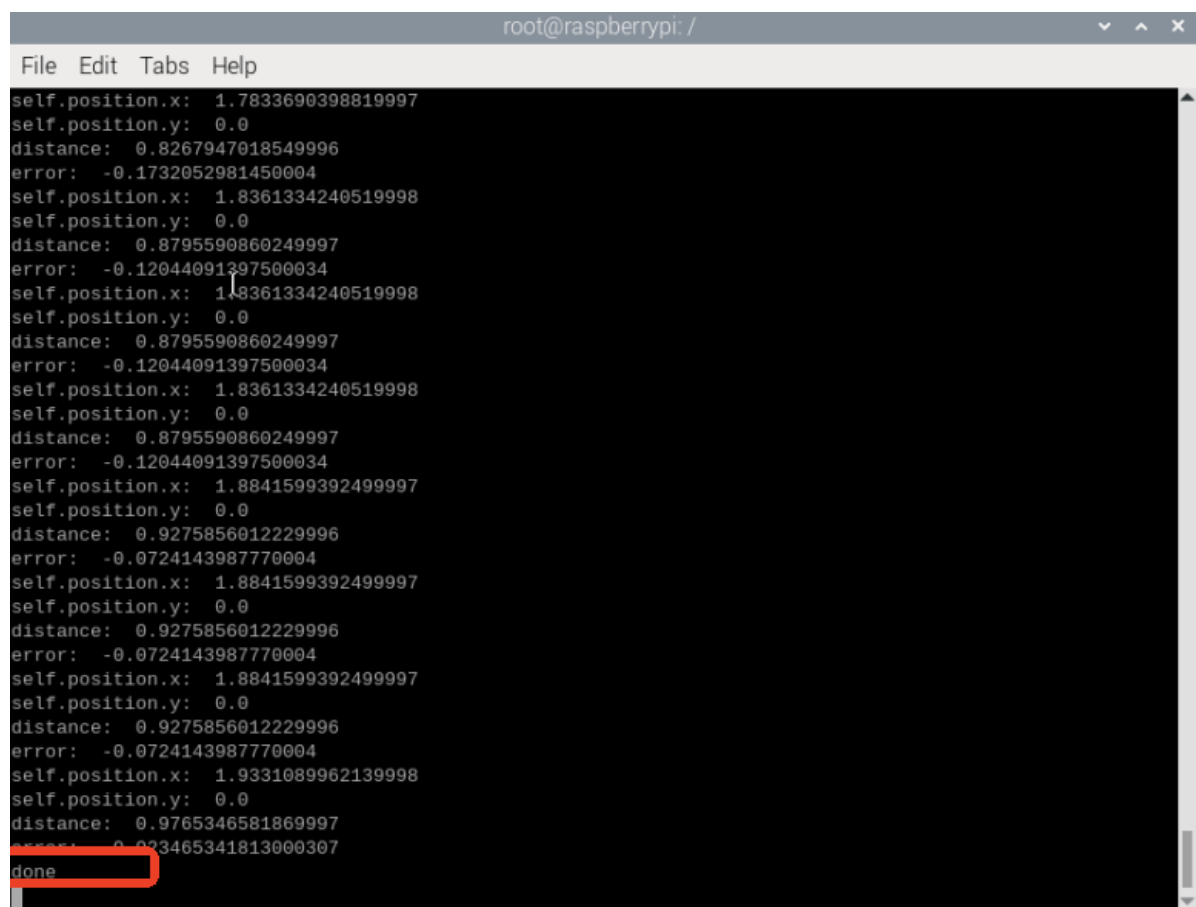
- test_distance: Calibration test distance. Here, the test is a 1-meter forward movement.
- speed: Linear speed.
- tolerance: Error tolerance.
- odom_linear_scale_correction: Linear speed scaling factor. If the test results are unsatisfactory, adjust this value.
- start_test: Test switch.
- direction: Can be ignored. This value is used for the McLennan robot. Modifying it allows you to calibrate the linear speed of left and right movements.
- base_frame: The name of the base coordinate system.
- odom_frame: The name of the odometry coordinate system.

2.2. Start Calibration

In the rqt_reconfigure interface, select the calibrate_linear node (click **Refresh** if it doesn't appear).

Select a reference of known length on the ground (a tape measure, tile, etc.). Change **test_distance** to the actual test distance (1 meter is used as an example). Click the **start_test** box to begin calibration.

After clicking start_test, calibration begins. The robot will monitor the TF transformations of base_footprint and odom, calculate the theoretical distance traveled, and when the error is less than tolerance, issue a stop command and the terminal will print "done." If the actual distance traveled is less than 1 meter, increase the **odom_linear_scale_correction** parameter appropriately. After making these changes, click a blank space, click start_test again, reset the start_test value, and click start_test again to complete the calibration. Modifying other parameters is similar; click a blank space to write the modified parameters. Record the final calibrated **odom_linear_scale_correction** parameter.

A screenshot of a terminal window titled 'root@raspberrypi: /'. The terminal displays a series of log messages for a calibration process. Each message block contains 'self.position.x', 'self.position.y', 'distance', and 'error' values. The 'distance' values fluctuate around 0.87 and 0.92. The 'error' values are consistently small, mostly between -0.12 and -0.07. The final line of the log shows 'done' in a red box, indicating the end of the calibration process.

```
root@raspberrypi: /
File Edit Tabs Help
self.position.x: 1.7833690398819997
self.position.y: 0.0
distance: 0.8267947018549996
error: -0.1732052981450004
self.position.x: 1.8361334240519998
self.position.y: 0.0
distance: 0.8795590860249997
error: -0.12044091397500034
self.position.x: 1.8361334240519998
self.position.y: 0.0
distance: 0.8795590860249997
error: -0.12044091397500034
self.position.x: 1.8361334240519998
self.position.y: 0.0
distance: 0.8795590860249997
error: -0.12044091397500034
self.position.x: 1.8841599392499997
self.position.y: 0.0
distance: 0.9275856012229996
error: -0.0724143987770004
self.position.x: 1.8841599392499997
self.position.y: 0.0
distance: 0.9275856012229996
error: -0.0724143987770004
self.position.x: 1.8841599392499997
self.position.y: 0.0
distance: 0.9275856012229996
error: -0.0724143987770004
self.position.x: 1.9331089962139998
self.position.y: 0.0
distance: 0.9765346581869997
error: -0.023465341813000307
done
```

After testing, remember the value of odom_linear_scale_correction and modify it to the linear_scale_x parameter in yahboomcar_bringup_A1_launch.py.

Path:

```
~/yahboomcar_ros2_ws/yahboomcar_ws/src/yahboomcar_bringup/launch/yahboomcar_bringup_A1_launch.py
```


- The `calibrate_linear` node monitors the TF transformation from `odom` to `base_footprint` and publishes to the topic (`/cmd_vel`) to control the robot's chassis movement.

4. Core Source Code Analysis

This program primarily utilizes TF monitoring of coordinate transformations. By monitoring the coordinate transformation between `base_footprint` and `odom`, the robot can determine "how far I've traveled" or "how many degrees I've turned."

Code path:

```
~/yahboomcar_ros2_ws/yahboomcar_ws/src/yahboomcar_bringup/yahboomcar_bringup/calibrate_angular_A1.py
```

Among them, the implementation of monitoring tf coordinate transformation is the `get_position` method in the `CalibrateLinear` class:

```
def get_position(self):
    try:
        now = rclpy.time.Time()
        transform = self.tf_buffer.lookup_transform(
            self.base_frame,
            self.odom_frame,
            now,
            timeout=rclpy.duration.Duration(seconds=1.0))
        return transform

    except (LookupException, ConnectivityException, ExtrapolationException):
        self.get_logger().info('transform not ready')
        raise
```

The `on_timer` method (timer callback function) in the `CalibrateLinear` class is used to determine the displacement of the robot chassis and control its movement:

```
def on_timer(self):
    move_cmd = Twist()
    #self.get_param()
    self.start_test =
self.get_parameter('start_test').get_parameter_value().bool_value
    self.odom_linear_scale_correction =
self.get_parameter('odom_linear_scale_correction').get_parameter_value().double_value
    self.rate = self.get_parameter('rate').get_parameter_value().double_value
    self.test_distance =
self.get_parameter('test_distance').get_parameter_value().double_value
    self.direction =
self.get_parameter('direction').get_parameter_value().double_value
    self.tolerance =
self.get_parameter('tolerance').get_parameter_value().double_value
    self.speed = self.get_parameter('speed').get_parameter_value().double_value
    if self.start_test:
        self.position.x = self.get_position().transform.translation.x
        self.position.y = self.get_position().transform.translation.y
        print("self.position.x: ",self.position.x)
        print("self.position.y: ",self.position.y)
        distance = sqrt(pow((self.position.x - self.x_start), 2) +
```

```

        pow((self.position.y - self.y_start), 2))
distance *= self.odom_linear_scale_correction
print("distance: ",distance)
error = distance - self.test_distance
print("error: ",error)
#start = time()
if not self.start_test or abs(error) < self.tolerance:
    self.start_test =
rcipy.parameter.Parameter('start_test',rcipy.Parameter.Type.BOOL,False)
    all_new_parameters = [self.start_test]
    self.set_parameters(all_new_parameters)

    print("done")
else:
    move_cmd.linear.x = copysign(self.speed, -1 * error)
    '''if self.direction:
        print("x")
        move_cmd.linear.x = copysign(self.speed, -1 * error)
    else:
        move_cmd.linear.y = copysign(self.speed, -1 * error)
        print("y")'''
self.cmd_vel.publish(move_cmd)

else:
    self.x_start = self.get_position().transform.translation.x
    self.y_start = self.get_position().transform.translation.y

    self.cmd_vel.publish(Twist())

```

